Topic 2: Cognitive psychology

Topic overview

Students must show understanding that cognitive psychology is about the role of cognition/cognitive processes in human behaviour. Processes include perception, memory, selective attention, language and problem solving. The cognitive topic area draws on the likeness of cognitive processing to computer processing.

Individual differences and developmental psychology must be considered when learning about memory differences, memory deficits and how this develops as the brain ages.

Subject content	What students need to learn:
2.1 Content	Memory 2.1.1 The working memory model (Baddeley and Hitch, 1974). 2.1.2 The multi-store model of memory (Atkinson and Shiffrin, 1968), including short- and long-term memory, and ideas about information processing, encoding, storage and retrieval, capacity and duration. 2.1.3 Explanation of long-term memory – episodic and semantic memory (Tulving, 1972). 2.1.4 Reconstructive memory (Bartlett, 1932) including schema theory.
	2.1.5 Individual differences in memory • Memory can be affected by individual differences in processing speed or by schemas that guide the reconstructive nature of memory. • Autobiographical memory is by nature individual. 2.1.6 Developmental psychology in memory, including at least one of these: • Sebastián and Hernández-Gil (2012) discuss developmental issues in memory span development, which is low at 5-years old, then develops as memory develops, up to 17-years old. • Dyslexia affects children's memory, span and working memory which can affect their learning. • The impact of Alzheimer's on older people and the effects on their memory.